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TAB 13



Board of Education Report

File #: Rep-021-25/26, **Version:** 1**Agenda Date:** 8/26/2025**In Control:** Facilities

Consideration of Street Lighting Maintenance Assessment for the Gratts Early Education Center Lighting District

Facilities Services Division

Brief Description:

(Consideration of Street Lighting Maintenance Assessment for the Gratts Early Education Center Lighting District) Recommends the Board of Education authorize the Chief Facilities Executive and/or her designee to cast the Proposition 218 ballot(s) in support of the street lighting maintenance assessment for the Gratts Early Education Center Lighting District (Lighting District) within the City of Los Angeles (City) and execute any other reasonable instruments on behalf of Los Angeles Unified in an amount not to exceed \$9,506.92 annually (not including annual Consumer Price Index (CPI) increases).

Action Proposed:

Authorize the Chief Facilities Executive and/or her designee to cast the Proposition 218 ballot(s) in support of the street lighting maintenance assessment for the Lighting District and execute any other reasonable instruments on behalf of Los Angeles Unified in an amount not to exceed \$9,506.92 annually (not including annual CPI increases).

Background:

The Department of Public Works, Bureau of Street Lighting within the City of Los Angeles is proposing a street lighting maintenance assessment for the Lighting District to add, maintain, and operate 27 new streetlights along the perimeter of 30 parcels located on Hartford Ave., 4th Street, W 5th Street, Lucas Ave., W 3rd Street, and Witmer Street in Los Angeles. Of these, 20 streetlights would be installed along the perimeter of Gratts Learning Academy for Young Scholars (GLAYS) and Gratts Early Education Center (Schools), as identified in Exhibit A. The Lighting District will need to submit ballots to property owners to vote on the assessment and to install the additional streetlights. The Lighting District provides servicing, installation, maintenance, and operation of street lighting. The cost for services includes but is not limited to electricity, lamps, fixtures, poles, wires, repair crews, and other items necessary to operate streetlights in the City. The additional lighting will further enhance safety measures and support safety passages.

Los Angeles Unified currently pays \$2,410.94 annually for 40 existing streetlights in this area. If approved and implemented, the annual amount for the special assessment projected by the Lighting District for the Schools would increase to \$9,506.92 annually. This adjustment reflects several key factors: the existing assessment amounts have not been updated for inflation since 1997 due to Prop 218, which froze rates for over 25 years, and the methodology has changed from calculating rates based on property frontage to acreage, resulting in larger parcels incurring higher assessments. Additionally, the inclusion of street lighting, which requires more poles with closer spacing, adds a significant layer of maintenance costs, further contributing to the adjusted rates. The proposed assessment is subject to annual increases based on the Lighting District budget.

The Lighting District is located in Region East and Board District 2 (Dr. Rocio Rivas).

Expected Outcomes:

Approval of the action will authorize Staff to execute the ballot in support of the proposed lighting assessment provided by the Lighting District and pay the annual assessment for the Lighting District. The increased lighting will help further enhance safe passages to and from school for students attending the Schools.

Board Options and Consequences:

A “Yes” vote by the Board will authorize Staff to record a yes vote on the Proposition 218 ballot for the Lighting District.

A “No” vote by the Board will authorize Staff to record a no vote on the Proposition 218 ballot for the Lighting District. This may result in the Lighting District failing to obtain a majority affirmative vote of the property owners in the Lighting District. However, if the Lighting District does secure the required support, Los Angeles Unified would still be obligated to pay the cost associated with the special assessments.

Policy Implications:

The proposed action advances Los Angeles Unified’s 2022-2026 Strategic Plan Pillar 3 Engagement and Collaboration Leading for Impact by growing and leveraging partnerships with community-based organizations. Moreover, it supports the District’s Every School Safe: A Blueprint for Safety.

Budget Impact:

The projected annual amount for the assessment of the Lighting District in 2026 would be increased from \$2,410.94 to \$9,506.92 and subject to increases based on the Lighting District budget annually thereafter. Annual assessment for the Lighting District will be provided by General Fund Street Lighting Assessments Program 15190. This is a new cost, but the program has adequate funding to support this assessment. The assessment is an ongoing annual cost and does not have a sunset date.

Student Impact:

Improve safety measures and support safe passages around the school perimeter and surrounding neighborhood.

Equity Impact:

A lighting district is a geographically defined area within the City, in which services, maintenance, and operations are paid for through a special assessment, which is charged to all members within the district in order to equitably distribute the benefits received and the costs incurred to provide the agreed-upon services, activities, and operations.

Issues and Analysis:

Article 13 D (Proposition 218) of the State Constitution requires that a parcel’s assessment may not exceed the reasonable cost for the proportional special benefit conferred on that parcel. Article 13 D provides that only special benefits are assessable, and the City must separate the general benefits from the special benefits. It also requires that publicly owned properties, which benefit from the improvements, be assessed.

The Bureau of Street Lighting is in the process of creating a Citywide Lighting District, which will require a new Engineer’s Report and an updated methodology for calculating street lighting maintenance assessment rates. Each parcel-including all Los Angeles Unified properties-will be evaluated to determine the proportionate special benefit conferred to each property. The proposed Citywide Lighting District and new Engineer’s Report will require approval by the Mayor’s Office and City Council, to establish the new Citywide Lighting District within the next two-three years. Currently, each parcel’s assessment is calculated in accordance with the Land

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Use Methodology outlined in the Street Lighting Engineer's Report. Assessments are primarily based on the parcel's land use, size (using a table of size ranges rather than a simple per-square-foot calculation), and the equipment type of the lighting system. Additional consideration is given for any benefit-qualifying factors, such as parcel shape and partial lighting. In accordance with City assessment standards, Los Angeles Unified will pay no more than other property owners for comparable parcels and benefits.

Los Angeles Unified is not obligated to support the formation of the Lighting District. Regardless of Los Angeles Unified's support, if the Lighting District is approved, Los Angeles Unified will be required to pay its special assessment unless there has been a formal determination that it is exempt.

The City has limited funding to provide certain services, and the Lighting District is able to supplement services that may benefit the community. Supporting the Lighting District is voluntary by the Board, however Los Angeles Unified is obligated to pay the special assessment should the City Council vote to pass the Lighting District ballot presented.

Attachments:

Exhibit A - Area Map Gratts Learning Academy for Young Sholars (GLAYS), Gratts Early Education Center
Exhibit B - Aerial Map

Submitted:

07/31/25

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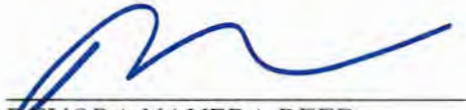
RESPECTFULLY SUBMITTED,


ALBERTO M. CARVALHO
Superintendent

APPROVED BY:


PEDRO SALCIDO
Deputy Superintendent,
Business Services and Operations

REVIEWED BY:


DEVORA NAVERA REED
General Counsel

☒ Approved as to form.

APPROVED BY:


KRISZTINA TOKES
Chief Facilities Executive
Facilities Services Division

REVIEWED BY:


KURT E. JOHN
Deputy Chief Financial Officer

☒ Approved as to budget impact statement.

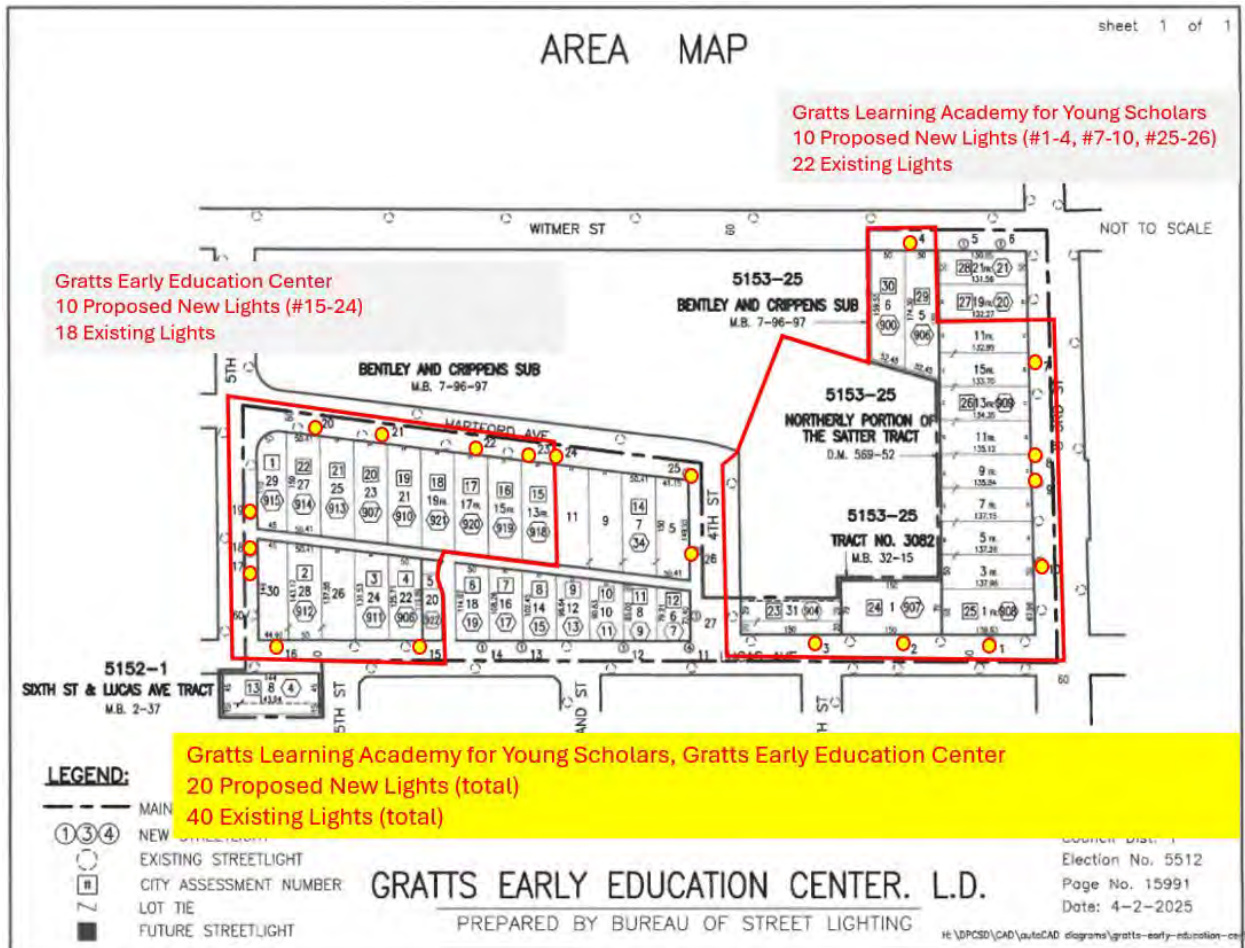
PRESENTED BY:


ISSAM DAHDUL
Director of Facilities
Planning and Development
Facilities Services Division

Exhibit A

Area Map

Gratts Learning Academy for Young Scholars (GLAYS), Gratts Early Education Center



● 20 Proposed New Lights (#1-4, #7-10, #15-26)

40 Existing Lights

Exhibit B

Aerial Map

